

SeaWorld

SAN DIEGO



CONFIDENTIAL
STRATEGY PROPOSAL

GUEST EXPERIENCE STRATEGY

Guest Experience Strategy

Food, Beverage, Seasonal Programming, and
Community Engagement for SeaWorld San Diego.

PREPARED FOR

SeaWorld San Diego
Guest Experience Leadership

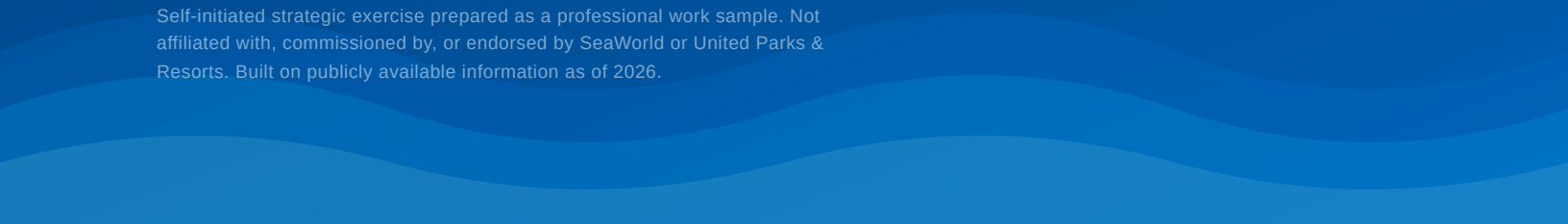
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Self-initiated strategic exercise prepared as a professional work sample. Not affiliated with, commissioned by, or endorsed by SeaWorld or United Parks & Resorts. Built on publicly available information as of 2026.



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A practical plan to grow year-round value



This proposal sets out a guest experience strategy for SeaWorld San Diego across three connected areas: food and beverage, seasonal programming, and community engagement. The aim is measured, achievable growth in the numbers that matter most to a membership-led park, delivered in phases and built on strengths the park already holds.

The approach. The strategy is organized around five pillars and a five year rollout. Every recommendation connects to one or more measurable goals, and each is scoped to be realistic for a park already running a full calendar. Accessibility, operations, staffing, and sustainability are treated as design constraints throughout, not as additions made at the end.

The focus. The largest opportunities sit in the space between the park's seasonal peaks: an everyday reason to return, a stronger daily food and beverage habit, a clearer membership rhythm, and a digital and community presence that keeps the park in a guest's life between visits. None of it depends on a major capital project.

3

Focus areas: food and beverage, seasonal programming, and community engagement.

5

Strategic pillars, sequenced across a five year rollout.

10

Business goals every recommendation is measured against.

PRIMARY GOALS

Repeat visitation

Annual passholder retention

Food & beverage revenue

Guest spending

Guest satisfaction

What is shaping the category

A calm read of where guest behavior is heading, and why it favors a park like SeaWorld San Diego.

- **Membership and frequency lead the economics.** Across the category, operators find that guests who visit several times a year spend more and renew more often than one-time visitors. Frequency, not single admission, is where durable value now sits.
- **Food and beverage has become a reason to visit.** Guests increasingly plan visits around food, and food and beverage is a growing share of per-guest spend. Quality and variety now influence the decision to come, not only the decision once inside.
- **A daily habit product lowers the bar to return.** Coffee and grab-and-go items give guests a low-commitment reason to come back more often than a full day would, which supports both frequency and length of stay.
- **Seasonal programming spreads demand.** A continuous calendar reduces reliance on a few peak weeks and gives members a reason to return in every season rather than once a year.
- **The mobile app is now the main return channel.** The decision to come back is increasingly made between visits, on a phone. Apps have moved from convenience to the primary way a park stays present with a member.
- **Guest and creator content drives discovery.** For younger and family audiences, content made by other guests now influences consideration more than paid media, which rewards experiences that are worth sharing.

RELEVANT GOALS

Repeat visitation

Mobile app engagement

Creator generated content

Guest spending

A strong foundation to build on

This strategy adds an organizing plan to assets the park has already built and proven.

- **A coastal setting few competitors can match.** The Mission Bay location gives the park a natural connection to the ocean and a sense of place that supports a coastal food, beverage, and community identity.
- **Marine life and a genuine rescue mission.** SeaWorld has aided more than 43,000 ill, injured, and orphaned animals over sixty years through its rescue, rehabilitation, and return program. This is the asset that most sets the brand apart.
- **An established seasonal calendar.** Seven Seas Food Festival, Electric Ocean, Halloween programming, Bayside Brews, and Christmas Celebration already give the park distinct seasons and proven food and event capability.
- **A membership built for frequency.** The annual pass offers unlimited admission with no blackout dates and includes quarterly in-park credits, a mechanic that already rewards returning through the year.
- **A credible family and conservation positioning.** The park's standing with families and its conservation work are trusted and difficult for competitors to replicate.

The through line. Read together, these are not separate assets. They are the raw material for one continuous, year-round relationship with the guest, which is what the following sections are designed to build.

Where measured growth sits

Six areas, each framed as an opportunity to strengthen the guest experience and a specific business goal.

Everyday visitation

Reasons to return outside festival windows, so demand is less concentrated in peak weeks.

The morning daypart

Coffee and grab-and-go items that give a low-commitment reason to come and to stay longer.

Signature beverages

Photogenic, family-friendly drinks that guests want to share, extending reach at low cost.

The membership rhythm

A clearer year-round reason to use the pass and its quarterly credit, supporting renewal.

App engagement

A reason to open the app between visits, where the return decision is increasingly made.

Creators and community

A structured local program that turns guests and creators into a discovery channel.

GOALS ADDRESSED

Repeat visitation

Average length of stay

Passholder retention

Mobile app engagement

Social engagement

Brand affinity

Five pillars that organize the plan

Every recommendation in this proposal maps to one of these pillars and to the goals beneath it.

1

Everyday reasons to return

Give guests a reason to visit between the seasonal peaks, so the park feels present all year rather than a few times a season.

Goals: repeat visitation, average length of stay

2

Food and beverage as a destination

Treat food and drink as a reason to visit and a signature of the coastal setting, available at a consistent quality year-round.

Goals: food and beverage revenue, guest spending, guest satisfaction

3

The membership relationship

Turn the annual pass into a year-round relationship with a clear rhythm of value, anchored by the quarterly credit.

Goals: annual passholder retention, repeat visitation

4

Digital and community reach

Use the app and a local creator program to stay present between visits and to grow discovery through guests themselves.

Goals: mobile app engagement, social engagement, creator generated content, brand affinity

5

Responsible operations

Design for accessibility, staffing reality, and sustainability so growth is durable and consistent with the conservation mission.

Goals: guest satisfaction, brand affinity

A continuous calendar, not a set of peaks

Connect the seasons the park already owns, and add lighter moments in the quieter weeks using existing venues and staff.

The park already owns distinct seasons. The opportunity is to connect them into one calendar a guest can plan around, and to soften the gaps between them without adding operational strain.

Publish one year-round calendar

HOW Present the full year as a single planned sequence, so every season has a defined reason to visit that members can see in advance and plan around. This is packaging and communication rather than new events.

Add shoulder-season moments

HOW Introduce lightweight, lower-cost programming in slower weeks, for example a spring marine-science weekend or a fall coastal food weekend, staged in existing venues with existing teams to protect staffing and cost.

Give members first access

HOW Offer passholders a preview evening ahead of each major festival, pulling visitation earlier and adding a tangible membership benefit at little incremental cost.

MEASURED AGAINST

Repeat visitation

Average length of stay

Food & beverage revenue

Brand affinity

Food as a reason to visit, all year

A California-coastal identity, held at a consistent quality outside festival windows, and made easier to buy.

The park has proven appetite and capability during festivals. The strategy is to carry a version of that quality into the everyday menu, remove friction from ordering, and make inclusion the default so more guests can take part.

Hold festival quality year-round

HOW Keep a small, well-chosen set of the most popular festival items available outside festival windows, so food remains a reason to visit in every season rather than only a few weeks.

Mobile order and pay across outlets

HOW Let guests order and pay from the app to reduce queue time, improve throughput, and lift average check. This also eases pressure on staff during peak periods.

Inclusive menus by default

HOW Offer clear allergen-friendly, vegetarian, and children's options at every major outlet, so dietary needs and accessibility are met as standard rather than by exception.

MEASURED AGAINST

Food & beverage revenue

Guest spending

Guest satisfaction

Average length of stay

A daily habit, and a low-cost reason to return

Coffee is the lowest-commitment reason to come back, and a natural fit for a coastal morning.

A dedicated coffee program gives guests a reason to arrive earlier and stay longer, and gives members a small, frequent reason to return. Partnering with a local roaster keeps quality high and cost contained while adding regional credibility.

A signature coffee location with a local roaster

HOW Establish one year-round coffee concept with a respected San Diego roaster partner, giving the park a quality morning offer without building the capability from scratch.

App-linked reusable cup and loyalty

HOW Reward repeat coffee visits through the app and offer a reusable cup that reduces single-use waste. This supports app engagement, frequency, and sustainability at once.

Seasonal limited drinks

HOW Rotate limited seasonal drinks timed to the calendar, creating a reason to come now and content worth sharing.

MEASURED AGAINST

Repeat visitation

Mobile app engagement

Food & beverage revenue

Social engagement

Drinks worth sharing

A family-first, photogenic beverage line that travels on social, with alcohol kept within the existing footprint.

Signature drinks are among the most cost-effective ways to grow spend and reach at once. A photogenic, family-friendly line gives guests something to share, which supports social reach and creator content without paid media.

A signature non-alcoholic line

HOW Design a small line of coastal, family-friendly drinks built to be photographed and shared, available year-round and priced to lift per-guest spend.

Seasonal limited releases

HOW Rotate limited editions tied to each season to create urgency and a steady flow of guest content.

Keep alcohol within the existing footprint

HOW Maintain craft beer and wine within the current Bayside Brews footprint, tasteful and secondary to the family offer, so the program fits the brand and its audience.

MEASURED AGAINST

Social engagement

Creator generated content

Guest spending

Brand affinity

Three concepts that reuse what exists

Each concept refreshes current infrastructure rather than building new, keeping cost and operational risk contained.

Waterfront Table

Refresh an existing sit-down venue around a California coastal menu and view seating. A modest refit, not a rebuild, that gives families a reason to sit, stay, and spend, supporting length of stay and food and beverage revenue.

The Year-Round Stall

Convert the most popular Seven Seas Food Festival concept into a permanent outlet, so a proven favorite is available in every season. This carries festival appetite into the everyday menu at low build cost.

Coastal Market

A grab-and-go market for families that supports mobile order and speeds throughput during peak periods. It improves convenience and eases staffing pressure while lifting incidental spend.

Cost discipline. All three reuse existing venues and kitchens. The intent is to refresh and repurpose proven spaces, reserving any larger investment for a concept the first phase has shown guests will return for.

MEASURED AGAINST

Food & beverage revenue

Average length of stay

Guest satisfaction

The app as the operating layer of a visit

A small, reliable core that plans the visit, powers ordering, and keeps the park present between visits.

The app should do a few things well rather than many things poorly. Its purpose is to make a visit easier and to give a member a reason to open it when they are at home, which is where the return decision is now made.

Make the app the operating layer of a visit

HOW Bring mobile order, wait times, show schedules, and quarterly credit redemption into one place, so planning and spending are easier and faster on the day.

Bring the mission into the app

HOW Let members follow rescue and return updates in the app, giving a reason to open it between visits that no competitor can offer.

A guest content hub

HOW Feature guest and creator posts inside the app to encourage sharing and to surface the moments worth planning a visit around.

MEASURED AGAINST

Mobile app engagement

Repeat visitation

Guest spending

Passholder retention

Turn the pass into a year-round relationship

Use the mechanics already in place, above all the quarterly credit, to build a clear rhythm of value.

The pass already rewards frequency. The opportunity is to make its value legible across the year, so members have a clear reason to return each season and a clear reason to renew.

Give the quarterly credit a seasonal reason

HOW Pair each quarterly credit with a seasonal reason to use it, such as a festival item or a limited beverage, so the credit drives a visit rather than going unredeemed.

Member preview nights at every festival

HOW Give members first access to each season, adding a benefit that costs little and strengthens the reason to renew.

Member food and beverage perks

HOW Offer simple, recognizable member perks such as early access to limited releases, deepening the everyday value of the pass.

MEASURED AGAINST

Annual passholder retention

Repeat visitation

Guest spending

Turn guests into the reach

A structured local program and shareable moments that grow discovery, supported by community events tied to the mission.

For family and younger audiences, discovery increasingly comes from other guests. A structured program, rather than one-off invitations, makes that reach dependable and keeps the park connected to its local community.

A structured local creator program

HOW Work with local family, food, and lifestyle creators through clear briefs and passes rather than one-off comps, so content is consistent and measurable.

Design shareable moments into every season

HOW Build one or two photogenic moments into each season, from beverages to seasonal installations, so guests have something worth sharing without prompting.

Community events tied to the mission

HOW Host coastal cleanups and marine-science days with credible partners, connecting the brand to the community and the conservation mission at low operational risk.

MEASURED AGAINST

Social engagement

Creator generated content

Brand affinity

Repeat visitation

Consistent with the mission, realistic to run

Guest-facing and operational steps that fit the conservation story and the operating budget.

Sustainability is most credible when it is specific and visible. The steps below are cost-aware, feasible for staff, and consistent with a conservation mission the park already lives.

A reusable cup and cutlery program

HOW Link a reusable cup to app loyalty in the coffee and beverage programs, reducing single-use waste while supporting frequency and app engagement.

Local and responsible sourcing

HOW Source the food and beverage core menu locally and responsibly where practical, supporting the coastal identity and reducing footprint without raising cost unreasonably.

Publish modest, verifiable commitments

HOW Share specific, measurable commitments rather than broad claims, so the mission is expressed through visible action and guests can see the progress.

MEASURED AGAINST

Brand affinity

Guest satisfaction

How progress is measured

Two program-level numbers lead. Each initiative also carries its own measures, set against a baseline.

The program is held above all to **repeat visitation** and **annual passholder retention**. If guests return more often and members renew, the strategy is working. The scorecard below connects each pillar to the goals it moves.

PILLAR	PRIMARY METRIC	SUPPORTING METRICS
Everyday return	Repeat visitation	Average length of stay; out-of-season visits
Food & beverage	Food and beverage revenue	Spend per guest; guest satisfaction
Membership	Annual passholder retention	Credit redemption; visits per member
Digital & community	Mobile app engagement	Social engagement; creator content; brand affinity
Responsible operations	Guest satisfaction	Waste reduction; accessibility feedback
Program	Repeat visitation & passholder retention	All of the above, reviewed quarterly

On baselines. Each target is set as an increment over a measured baseline for SeaWorld San Diego, not as an absolute figure promised in advance. A first baseline reading of visitation, food and beverage spend, retention, and app engagement should be taken before Year One activity begins, so the effect of the work can be read cleanly.

Sequenced, and paced to the operation

Lower-cost, higher-connective moves come first. Each year is built to return value on its own.

YEAR	FOCUS	KEY MOVES
Year 1	Foundation	Ship the app core loop and mobile order; open the coffee concept; launch member preview nights; publish the connected year-round calendar.
Year 2	Build	Launch the signature beverage line and reusable cup program; refresh the first restaurant concept (Waterfront Table); start the creator program.
Year 3	Expand	Convert the year-round stall; add shoulder-season moments; shift the core menu toward local sourcing; add member food and beverage perks.
Year 4	Deepen	Open the Coastal Market; scale community events; publish and track sustainability commitments; expand creator partnerships.
Year 5	Optimize	Review every initiative against its baseline; reset targets; scale what worked and retire what did not.

The sequence is deliberate. The app, coffee, mobile order, and member rhythm come first because they cost the least and do the most to connect the guest to the park across the year. Food, restaurant, and community investments build on that base, and each year is scoped so that staffing and operations are never asked to absorb too much change at once.

The recommendation, in short



SeaWorld San Diego does not need to become something new. It needs its existing strengths, the setting, the calendar, the food, the pass, and the conservation mission, to work together across the whole year rather than in separate seasons.

The practical path is to begin with the moves that cost the least and connect the most: the app, a coffee program, mobile order, and a clearer membership rhythm. Food, beverage, restaurant, and community investments then build on that base at a pace the operation can carry. Everything is held to two numbers, repeat visitation and annual passholder retention, with each initiative measured against a local baseline.

Accessibility, staffing, and sustainability are built into each recommendation rather than added at the end, which keeps the plan realistic to run and consistent with the brand's standing with families and its conservation mission.

Suggested next step. A short working session to take the Year One baseline readings, confirm scope, and agree the two program-level measures this strategy will be judged against. From there, the first year of work can begin without waiting on later phases.

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References: SeaWorld San Diego events and annual pass information, seaworld.com/san-diego (2026); United Parks & Resorts animal rescue, rehabilitation, and return program, unitedparks.com/commitment (2026). Public information as of 2026. This document is an independent work sample and is not affiliated with or endorsed by SeaWorld or United Parks & Resorts.